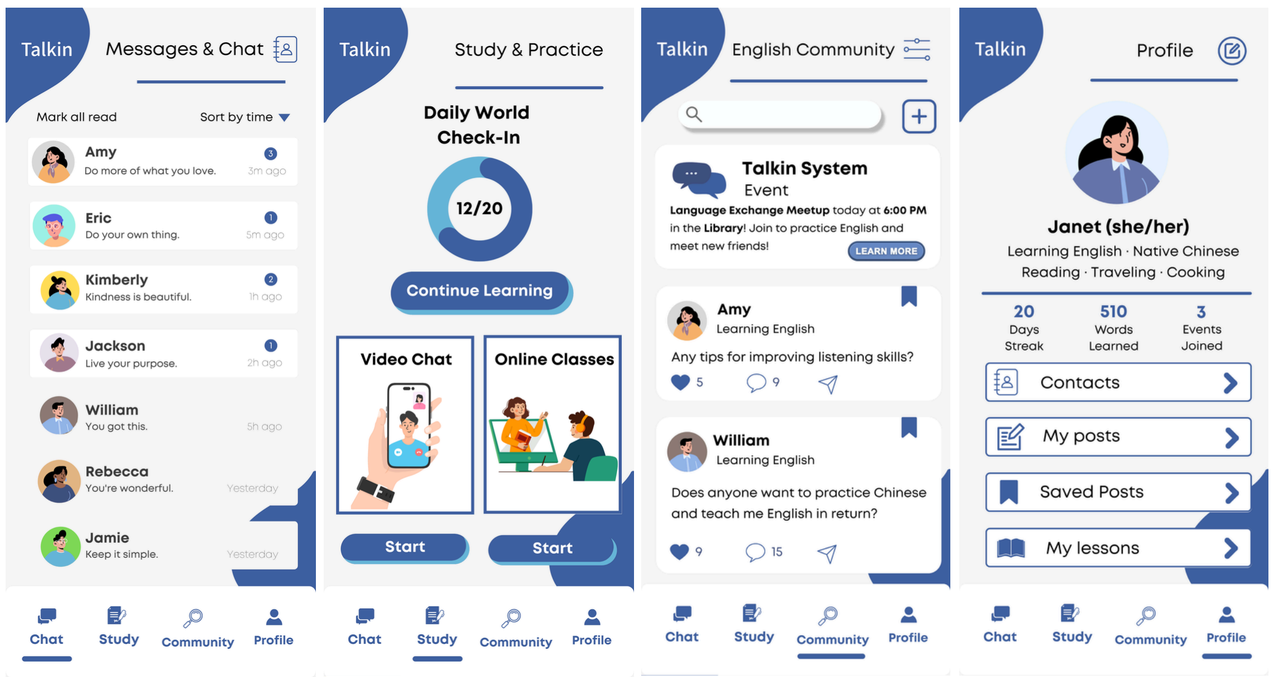
Talkin

A Language Learning and Community Integration App for International Students and New Immigrants



Users

The target audience of Talkin primarily consists of international students and new immigrants. International students are mostly young adults aged 18–30. According to IRCC (2024), there were 468,087 international students in Canada during the 2022/2023 year, and the number is projected to reach 305,900 by 2025 (Statistics Canada, 2024). New immigrants are typically in the core working-age group of 25–45, and Canada admitted 104,256 new permanent residents in the first quarter of 2025, with an estimated 367,750 for the full year. (Statistics Canada, 2025).

In terms of social and behavioral characteristics, the target audience demonstrates strong motivation for language learning and social practice. Firstly, they are individuals who want to learn a second language to meet academic, professional, or travel needs. Secondly, some users are interested in becoming language tutors, offering online lessons to practice with learners while earning extra income.

For psychological characteristics, the audience exhibits strong emotional and social needs. Firstly, they want to make new friends and expand their social circles to reduce isolation. Secondly, they seek to integrate into local communities and gain a sense of belonging through participation in community activities.

User Motivations

- **Social Motivation**
  - Desire to learn a new language, integrate into a new community, and make new friends through online learning and community activities.
- **Psychological Motivation**
  - Reduce loneliness and gain emotional support and a sense of belonging.
  - Achieve self-improvement and a sense of accomplishment through active language learning.
- **Lifestyle Motivation**
  - Language learning is essential for academics, work, and daily life.
  - Participation in local events helps understand culture and adapt to new surroundings.
- **Demographic Motivation**
  - Young international students (18–30) and new immigrants (25–45) commonly have strong language learning and social needs.

Functionality

First, it offers personalized registration and profile creation, where new users provide basic personal information to enable intelligent language partner matching and personalized community recommendations. Creating user profiles is an effective way to increase engagement and encourage participation (Fogg & Iizawa, 2008, p. 37). After registration, users can access a daily vocabulary check-in and personalized learning module, completing daily word-learning tasks and sharing their progress on personal feeds to stay motivated. Observing friends' sharing has been shown to encourage newcomers to contribute more actively (Burke et al., 2009, p. 1). Demonstrating the effect of social learning.

To enhance user interaction, Talkin offers random video chats with other users, as well as optional matching by language, age, gender, or interests. Also, offers live and recorded online classes from professional language teachers to help users overcome language barriers. As Bayer et al. (2015) note, immediate voice and video interaction is a lightweight social activity that fosters positive emotions and social connection. In addition, the app features language-specific community forums, where users can post learning experiences, ask questions, or share local life information to build active weak-tie social networks. Ellison et al. (2011) note that such weak ties help build bridging social capital by providing access to information and resources.

Furthermore, Talkin provides location-based community event recommendations to help new immigrants integrate into local society more quickly. As Wilken (2014) notes, location-based services extend online networks into offline spaces and promote local engagement. Finally, the app provides social media-style communication features, allowing users to send messages, share posts, and interact with new friends.

Barriers to Adoption

- **Individual Limitations**
  - **Demographics and lifestyle:** International students and new immigrants often face financial and time barriers. Students are burdened by heavy coursework and high tuition fees, while newcomers are occupied with jobs or family care.
  - **Social or psychological traits:** Some people may feel isolated or experience social anxiety, which can reduce their participation in both online and offline interactions.
- **Technology Limitations**
  - Requires stable internet access.
  - Video chat features may trigger privacy concerns or fear of interacting with strangers.
  - Personalized recommendations require registration, but some users hesitate to share personal details.

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